

Firearms Trace Data: Ohio - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Ohio in Calendar Year 2023

20,543

Firearm Types with an Ohio Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	16,822
Rifles	1,384
Revolvers	1,354
Shotguns	709
Machinegun Conversion Devices	98
Derringers	89
Machineguns	41
Receivers/Frames	24
Other*	22

* Other includes Unknown Types, Any Other Weapons, Silencers, Combinations and Destructive Devices.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with an Ohio Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	10,777
.40 Cal	1,922
.380 Cal	1,431

.22 Cal	1,353
.45 Cal	1,075
.38 Cal	570
12GA	539
5.56mm	422
7.62mm	307
.357 Cal	283

NOTE: There were 1,613 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 251 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Ohio Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	6,664
Weapon Offense	3,248
Possession of Weapon	3,053
Found Firearm	2,314
Carrying Concealed Weapon	1,056
Dangerous Drugs	935
Family Offense	475
Homicide	456
Property Crimes	291
Aggravated Assault	256

NOTE: There were 1,795 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearm Traces with an Ohio Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Ohio	15,195
Kentucky	495
Indiana	305
West Virginia	216
Michigan	191
Florida	168
Georgia	152
Pennsylvania	150
Texas	141
Tennessee	113
Virginia	89
North Carolina	78
Alabama	68
South Carolina	60
California	45

NOTE: An additional 34 states, the District of Columbia and Puerto Rico accounted for 533 other traces. The source state was identified in 17,999 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Ohio Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	1,247
3 Months to Under 7 Months	1,171
7 Months to Under 1 Year	1,338
1 Year to Under 2 Years	2,856
2 Years to Under 3 Years	2,782
3 Years and Over	8,545

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Ohio Average Time-to-Crime: **5.92 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Ohio Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	886
18 to 21	1,956
22 to 24	1,534
25 to 30	2,546
31 to 40	3,560
41 to 50	2,046
Over 50	1,422

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Ohio Average Age of Possessor: **33 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Ohio Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Columbus	3,614
Cleveland	2,551
Cincinnati	2,383
Toledo	1,408
Dayton	1,324
Akron	1,005
Canton	347
Youngstown	292
Middletown	249
Springfield	237

NOTE: There were 597 additional municipalities that accounted for 7,028 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 105 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Ohio. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Ohio.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with an Ohio Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Ohio Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with an Ohio Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Ohio Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Ohio Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Ohio Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024